

D750

Early Clinical in Elementary and Special Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A candidate will observe a combined first-grade and special education co-taught class for 40 minutes. The room has a large aquarium and bright new carpet. Her course asks her to study how teachers get students' attention. How should she plan her notes?

- A. Describe the room's aquarium and carpet in detail.
- B. Write down everything that happens in the 40 minutes.
- C. Record every attention signal the teachers use and how many students respond within a few seconds.
- D. Rate the teachers' overall effectiveness.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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2.

A candidate times transitions in a second-grade class that recently got new cubbies. Each transition takes about 4 minutes longer than it should, and there are 6 transitions a day. The school year has 180 days. About how much instructional time is lost in a year?

- A. 4,320 minutes (72 hours)
- B. 720 minutes
- C. 24 minutes
- D. 1,080 minutes

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants to lose no more than 900 minutes a year to extra transition time. The class has 5 transitions a day for 180 days. What is the most extra time each transition can take?

- A. 5 minutes
- B. 1 minute
- C. 180 minutes
- D. 0 minutes, since any transition time is wasted.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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4.

A mentor asks a candidate to suggest changes to the room. The teacher's desk sits in front of the only window, and a tall bookshelf blocks the view of the reading corner from the small-group table. The district just bought new chairs. Which change matters most?

- A. Move the teacher's desk away from the window for better light.
- B. Add decorations to the reading corner.
- C. Move or lower the bookshelf so the reading corner is visible from the small-group table.
- D. Swap in the new chairs.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A candidate teaches third graders how to find the main idea. The class loves a read-aloud about a lost dog, and the lesson is right after recess. Which opening best uses think-aloud modeling?

- A. Read a paragraph and say, "Most sentences are about the dog getting lost, so I think that's the big idea; this detail about his collar supports it."
- B. Write the main idea on the board and ask students to copy it.
- C. Ask students to find the main idea on their own first.
- D. Read the whole lost dog book aloud for fun.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

After a teacher demonstrates long division silently on the board, students can copy the steps but cannot say why they bring down the next digit. What was missing from the modeling?

- A. A think-aloud that explains the reason for each decision while solving.
- B. More problems for independent practice.
- C. An answer key.
- D. A faster demonstration.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A fourth grader rarely speaks to adults and often puts his head down. The candidate learns he has three sisters and the class sits in rows this month. The mentor suggests the 2x10 strategy. What should the candidate do?

- A. Spend two minutes a day reviewing his missing work.
- B. Talk with him for about two minutes each day for ten days about his interests, not his work or behavior.
- C. Move him to sit near his sisters.
- D. Have one 20-minute talk on the first day.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

During an early clinical visit, the mentor steps out to take a call. A parent, who is also the PTA president, stops by and asks the candidate why her child got a low grade on a spelling test. What should the candidate do?

- A. Explain the grade using the gradebook.
- B. Greet her politely and say the mentor will follow up, then pass the message on.
- C. Tell her candidates can never talk to parents.
- D. Change the grade to avoid conflict with the PTA president.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which task is appropriate for an early field candidate to do on her own?

- A. Email a parent about a behavior concern.
- B. Enter final report card grades.
- C. Lead a small-group read-aloud the mentor planned with her.
- D. Assign a detention to a student.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A kindergartner with autism in an inclusive class rarely joins play centers. His classmate Maya is kind and is the class line leader this week. Which plan uses peer-mediated support well?

- A.** Tell Maya to be his buddy.
- B.** Let Maya take him to the front of the line.
- C.** Have Maya do his center work for him.
- D.** Teach Maya to invite him, show how to play, and praise him when he joins, then check in on how it goes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A peer buddy program is not working: buddies mostly ignore the student with a disability or do things for her. What is the most likely missing piece?

- A.** Peer support never works for students with disabilities.
- B.** The student should be moved to a separate room.
- C.** The student needs different buddies each day.
- D.** The buddies were not taught what to do and when.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

After a first lesson, a candidate gets five comments from her mentor about pacing, directions, voice, questioning, and materials. She teaches again Thursday, and her car needs new tires. What should she do first?

- A.** Try to fix all five areas on Thursday.
- B.** Write a goal to be a better teacher.
- C.** Postpone Thursday's lesson to get the tires fixed.
- D.** Pick one change, such as giving directions in three short steps and checking one student's understanding, and try it Thursday.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A candidate will observe a combined first-grade and special education co-taught class for 40 minutes. ~~The room has a large aquarium and bright new carpet.~~ Her course asks her to study how teachers get students' attention. How should she plan her notes?

Target word: plan an observation **Decides:** A single question guides what to record.

A	Camouflage	Irrelevant to attention signals.
B	Absolute language	Notes too broad to answer the question.
C	Correct	A focused lens yields evidence she can analyze.
D	Adjacent category	Evaluation, not focused observation.

2. Answer A Concept 2

A candidate times transitions in a second-grade class ~~that recently got new cubbies.~~ Each transition takes about 4 minutes longer than it should, and there are 6 transitions a day. The school year has 180 days. About how much instructional time is lost in a year?

Target word: yearly minutes lost **Decides:** $4 \times 6 \times 180$.

A	Correct	$4 \times 6 = 24$ minutes per day; $24 \times 180 = 4,320$ minutes = 72 hours.
B	Dropped element	4×180 drops the 6 transitions.
C	Dropped element	That is one day, dropping the 180 days.
D	Wrong stem number	6×180 uses transitions and days but drops the 4 minutes each.

3. Answer B Concept 2 · transfer

A teacher wants to lose no more than 900 minutes a year to extra transition time. The class has 5 transitions a day for 180 days. What is the most extra time each transition can take?

Target word: solve for minutes per transition **Decides:** $900 / (5 \times 180)$.

A	Wrong stem number	The transitions per day, not minutes.
B	Correct	$5 \times 180 = 900$ transitions; $900 / 900 = 1$ minute each.
C	Inverted operation	Divides 900 by 5 alone, giving per-day total.
D	Absolute language	Some transition time is necessary.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A mentor asks a candidate to suggest changes to the room. The teacher's desk sits in front of the only window, and a tall bookshelf blocks the view of the reading corner from the small-group table. ~~The district just bought new chairs.~~ Which change matters most?

Target word: priority layout fix **Decides:** The teacher cannot see a student area.

A	Adjacent category	A comfort issue, not supervision.
B	Dropped element	Drops the sightline issue.
C	Correct	Sightlines to every student come first.
D	Camouflage	Irrelevant to the visibility problem.

5. Answer A Concept 4

A candidate teaches third graders how to find the main idea. ~~The class loves a read-aloud about a lost dog, and the lesson is right after recess.~~ Which opening best uses think-aloud modeling?

Target word: what a think-aloud is **Decides:** Say the thinking out loud while doing the skill.

A	Correct	Makes the hidden decisions visible.
B	Dropped element	Shows the answer, not the thinking.
C	Inverted operation	Skips modeling and puts practice first.
D	Camouflage	Uses the book detail with no modeling.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

After a teacher demonstrates long division silently on the board, students can copy the steps but cannot say why they bring down the next digit. What was missing from the modeling?

Target word: reverse: diagnose from student results **Decides:** Steps were shown; reasoning was not voiced.

A	Correct	Voicing the thinking makes the why visible.
B	Inverted operation	More practice repeats steps without the missing reasoning.
C	Dropped element	Shows results, not thinking.
D	Confusion set	Speed does not add reasoning.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A fourth grader rarely speaks to adults and often puts his head down. The candidate learns ~~he has three sisters and the class sits in rows this month.~~ The mentor suggests the 2x10 strategy. What should the candidate do?

Target word: carry out 2x10 **Decides:** Two minutes, ten days, non-academic.

A	Adjacent category	Academic talk defeats the purpose.
B	Correct	That is the 2x10 structure.
C	Camouflage	Uses the sisters detail; unrelated.
D	Wrong stem number	Multiplies 2 × 10 into one session; the power is daily consistency.

8. Answer B Concept 6

During an early clinical visit, the mentor steps out to take a call. A parent, ~~who is also the PTA president,~~ stops by and asks the candidate why her child got a low grade on a spelling test. What should the candidate do?

Target word: role scope **Decides:** Grades and parent concerns are the mentor's decisions.

A	Inverted operation	Acts as teacher of record.
B	Correct	Early field candidates do not handle grade discussions independently.
C	Absolute language	Polite, directed contact is fine; decisions are not.
D	Camouflage	Status does not change the grade or the candidate's role.

9. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

Which task is appropriate for an early field candidate to do on her own?

Target word: reverse: allowed tasks **Decides:** Mentor-directed, low-stakes support.

A	Inverted operation	Parent communication belongs to the mentor.
B	Confusion set	Grading decision for the teacher of record.
C	Correct	A mentor-directed task within her scope.
D	Adjacent category	Discipline decision.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A kindergartner with autism in an inclusive class rarely joins play centers. His classmate Maya is kind ~~and is the class line leader this week~~. Which plan uses peer-mediated support well?

Target word: structure a peer support **Decides:** Peer is taught a specific role.

A	Dropped element	Drops the training and specific role.
B	Camouflage	Uses the line-leader detail; not support for play.
C	Inverted operation	Doing it for him removes his participation.
D	Correct	A trained peer with a clear role is the core of peer mediation.

11. Answer D Concept 7 · transfer

A peer buddy program is not working: buddies mostly ignore the student with a disability or do things for her. What is the most likely missing piece?

Target word: reverse: diagnose a weak peer plan **Decides:** Peers were not trained in a role.

A	Absolute language	Trained peer support is evidence-based.
B	Adjacent category	A placement change, not a fix to the program.
C	Confusion set	New untrained buddies have the same problem.
D	Correct	Peer-mediated support needs peer training.

12. Answer D Concept 8

After a first lesson, a candidate gets five comments from her mentor about pacing, directions, voice, questioning, and materials. She teaches again Thursday, ~~and her car needs new tires~~. What should she do first?

Target word: use feedback **Decides:** One specific change to try next.

A	Absolute language	Too many changes at once; none will be done well.
B	Dropped element	Vague goal without an action.
C	Camouflage	Irrelevant detail.
D	Correct	One specific, observable change can be tried and checked.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	3	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	A focused observation lens	Go into each observation with one question (for example, how the teacher gets attention) and collect evidence only on it.	Trying to write down everything and ending with notes too broad to learn from.	A candidate plans what to observe.
2	Transition time adds up	Minutes lost per transition × transitions per day × days shows how much learning time transitions cost, which justifies teaching them.	Treating a few minutes per transition as too small to matter.	A number of minutes per transition and a number of transitions.
3	Room arrangement and sightlines	Arrange the room so the teacher can see every student from any teaching spot and traffic paths stay clear.	Arranging for looks or for the teacher's desk first.	A layout where the teacher's view or paths are blocked.
4	Think-aloud modeling	The teacher shows the invisible thinking behind a skill by saying the decisions aloud while doing it, before students try.	Just showing the steps or the answer silently.	Students can see what to do but not why.
5	The 2x10 relationship strategy	Spend two minutes a day for ten days in a row talking with a hard-to-reach student about anything non-academic to build a relationship.	Using the time to talk about the student's behavior or grades.	A student who is withdrawn or often in conflict with adults.
6	The field candidate's scope	An early field candidate works under the mentor teacher's direction and does not make independent discipline, grading, or parent decisions.	Acting as the teacher of record because the mentor stepped out.	A situation calling for an authority decision.
7	Peer-mediated support	Train peers in a specific, simple role (model, prompt, praise) to support a classmate with a disability during class activities.	Pairing a student with a 'buddy' without teaching the buddy what to do.	A plan to use classmates to help a student with a disability.
8	Feedback into one next action	Turn each round of feedback into one specific, observable change to try next time, then check the result.	Trying to fix everything at once or writing vague goals like 'be better.'	After receiving several pieces of feedback.

Course scope (public description): Early Clinical Experiences is a pivotal course designed to bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical teaching skills. This course offers aspiring educators an immersive experience in real classroom settings under the mentorship of experienced teachers. Candidates engage in a range of activities, including observation, to develop a deeper understanding of classroom dynamics, student engagement, and effective instructional strategies. Emphasizing reflective practice, the course encourages participants to analyze their experiences, integrate feedback, and adapt their teaching methods accordingly. This experiential learning approach equips future teachers with the confidence and competence necessary to foster a positive and impactful learning environment for their students.